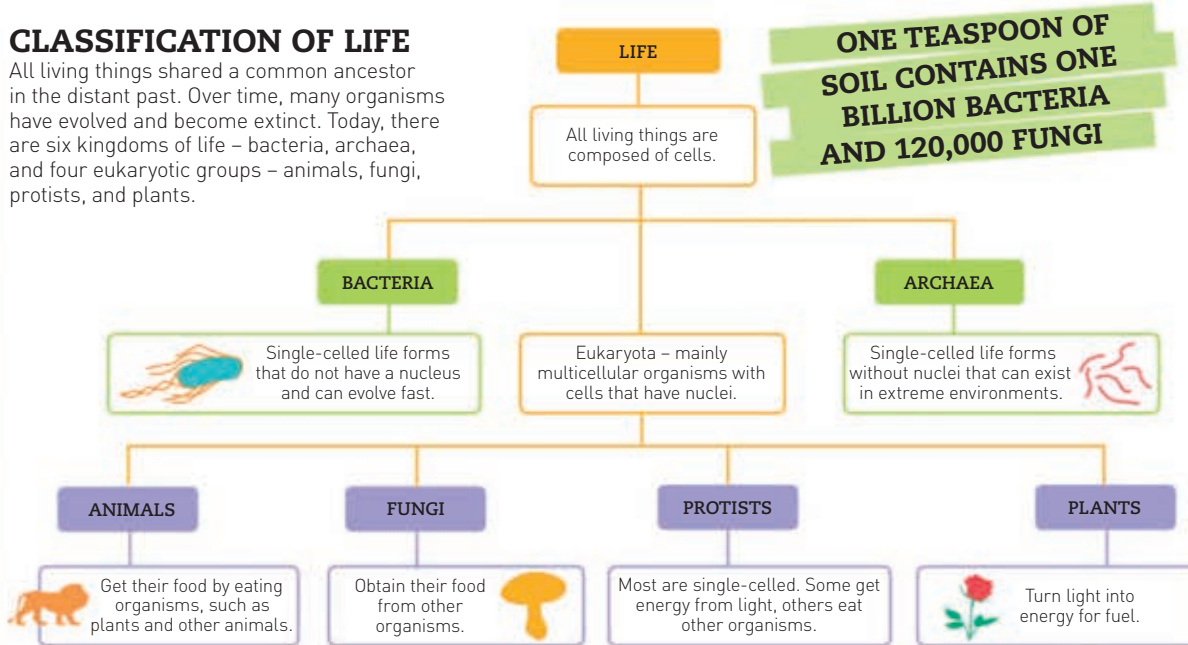


CLASSIFICATION OF LIFE

All living things shared a common ancestor in the distant past. Over time, many organisms have evolved and become extinct. Today, there are six kingdoms of life – bacteria, archaea, and four eukaryotic groups – animals, fungi, protists, and plants.



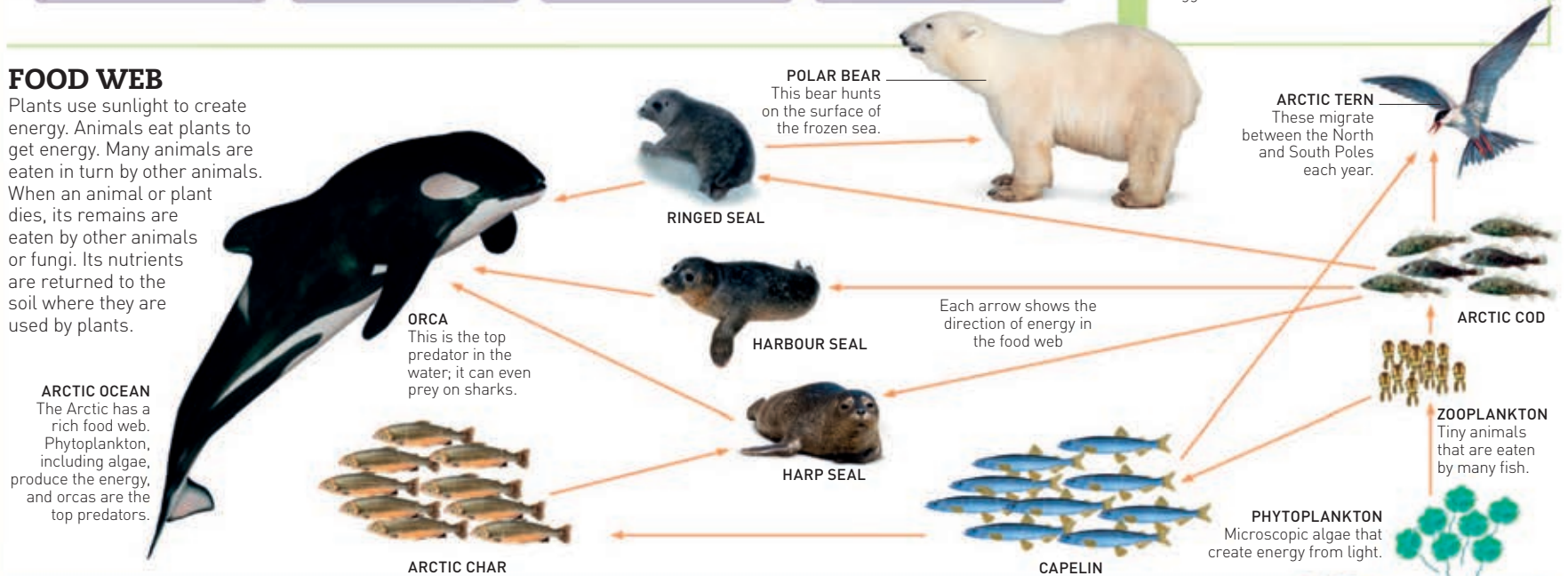
GREAT BIOLOGISTS

Biologists study living things and their relationship to each other and the world. Their discoveries and inventions have changed the way we live.

- ARISTOTLE (384–322 BCE)**
This Ancient Greek philosopher was the first to classify the kingdom of life.
- CHARLES DARWIN (1809–82)**
This British naturalist suggested the theory of evolution in his book *On the Origin of Species*.
- GREGOR MENDEL (1822–84)**
An Austrian scientist and monk, Mendel showed how traits are inherited.
- LOUIS PASTEUR (1822–95)**
Pasteur proved that bacteria can spoil food and then went on to invent pasteurization – a method of killing bacteria in food such as milk and cheese.
- LOUIS LEAKEY (1903–72)**
A Kenyan scientist who found evidence of early humans in Olduvai Gorge, Kenya, and suggested humans first evolved in Africa.

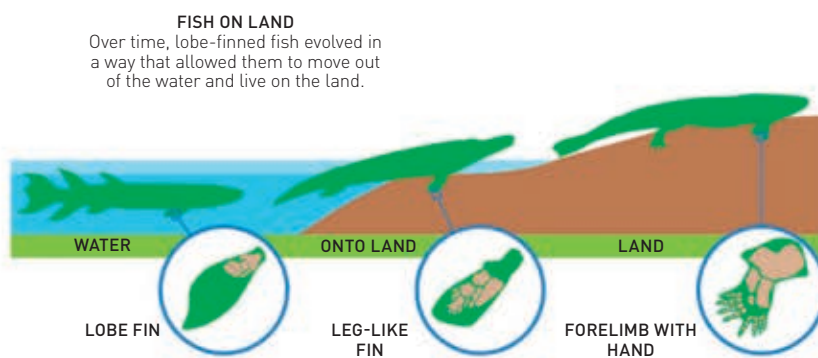
FOOD WEB

Plants use sunlight to create energy. Animals eat plants to get energy. Many animals are eaten in turn by other animals. When an animal or plant dies, its remains are eaten by other animals or fungi. Its nutrients are returned to the soil where they are used by plants.



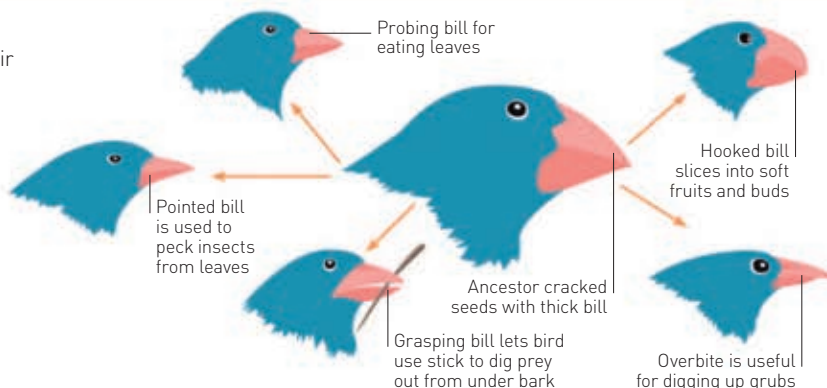
EVOLUTION

Individuals that are best suited to the environment in which they live are the ones most likely to survive and reproduce. They then pass on the genes that favour their existence to their offspring. Over time, this leads to change. This process is known as evolution by natural selection.



ADAPTATION

Animals adapt to suit their environment, and birds' beaks, or bills, are a perfect example of this. The birds pictured here have all evolved from the same ancestor, but their bills have become perfectly adapted to help them catch and eat food in different habitats.



EXTINCTION

The dying out of a species is known as "extinction". Scientists believe that we are now undergoing the biggest wave of extinctions since the dinosaurs disappeared.

